SWOT ANALYSIS

A simple tool for understanding a business, project, or idea



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What does SWOT stand for?

SWOT organizes information into four useful categories.

S Strengths

Internal advantages that help you succeed.

Example: loyal customers or a skilled team.

W Weaknesses

Internal limits or areas that need improvement.

Example: a small budget or limited experience.

O Opportunities

External chances for growth or improvement.

Example: a new market or rising demand.

T Threats

External challenges that could cause problems.

Example: strong competitors or higher costs.

Tip: Strengths and weaknesses are internal; opportunities and threats are external.

Internal factors: Strengths & Weaknesses

These are things an organization can usually influence or improve.

S STRENGTHS

- What do we do well?
- What resources or skills do we have?
- What makes us different?

Examples: good customer service, a strong reputation, experienced workers.

W WEAKNESSES

- What could we improve?
- What resources are we missing?
- Where do we struggle?

Examples: limited funding, low brand awareness, slow service.

A useful analysis is honest: it recognizes advantages without ignoring problems.

External factors: Opportunities & Threats

These come from outside the organization and may be harder to control.

O OPPORTUNITIES

- Are customer needs changing?
- Are there new markets or trends?
- Could we form useful partnerships?

Examples: growing demand, new technology, social media reach.

T THREATS

- Who are the competitors?
- What outside changes could hurt us?
- Are costs or rules changing?

Examples: new competitors, rising prices, changing customer preferences.

Opportunities can be used to grow; threats should be monitored and planned for.

Why is SWOT analysis useful?

It turns information into a clearer plan for making decisions.

1

Understand

See what is going well and what needs attention.

2

Plan

Use strengths, improve weaknesses, pursue opportunities, and prepare for threats.

3

Decide

Set priorities and choose realistic next steps.

Key takeaway

SWOT is most helpful when the results lead to action—not just a list of observations.

Questions?